

2.6 WHAT TO BUY

So, now that you have been updated with all the information you would ever need about the three next-gen video game consoles, the big question is all that remains: which is the best?

The answer is none. There can't be a 'best console', just like there cannot be a 'best phone' or 'best burger'. If I tell you that the chicken burger is the best, but if you don't like chicken, then it cannot be the universally 'best' option.

All the three consoles have certain pros and cons and the trick is in figuring out which one is the most ideally suited to you.

First, you have to figure out what kind of a gamer you are. Are you someone who is passionate about video games and will always be looking forward to the latest *Call of Duty* or *Halo* title? Or are you more of a social gamer, switching on your console to play with friends and family, while occasionally enjoying the odd game alone?

2.6.1 FOR SOCIAL GAMERS

If you fall into the latter, then your decision just became much easier. The Nintendo Wii is the console you want and there cannot be any argument about it. Sure, Xbox 360 and the PS3 offer several party games such as *Singstar*, *Guitar Hero* and *Rock Band*, but when it comes to having a blast with friends, there is nothing as cool as the Wii.

As an individual gamer, the Wii is still not bad to have around. Some of the single-player games for the Wii are nothing short of brilliant, with the likes of *No More Heroes* and the new *Legend of Zelda* giving you hours upon hours of sheer entertainment.

The key point here is what kind of priorities you have when it comes to gaming. If you are a serious gamer, then while the Wii has quite a few titles available for you, the other two consoles offer a lot more bang-for-buck. But for a social gamer, it's Wii all the way!

2.6.2 FOR SERIOUS GAMERS

So, with the idea of social gaming out of the window, it's now down to a decision between the Xbox 360 and the PlayStation 3 when you have acknowledged yourself as a serious gamer.

Price factor

The biggest factor in this decision is the moolah.

The lowest model of the PlayStation 3 retails at Rs. 25,000, with each game for it costing somewhere around Rs. 2,500. An extra controller would also set you back by Rs. 3,000. So if you were to buy a PS3 and an average of a single game in a month, that still comes out to an expenditure of Rs. 58,000 in a year. With two games a month, the expenditure goes up to Rs. 88,000 in a single year!